

Eye Pain and Other Symptoms - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1342 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric eye-pain pathway screening for sight-threatening disease, chemical exposure, trauma, acute glaucoma-pattern symptoms and contact-lens complications before urgent in-person ophthalmic assessment.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] Which eye hurts, where is the pain, how severe is it, and is onset sudden, worsening, deep, surface-like, with eye movement, or associated with headache?
2. [DURATION] What exact time did pain start, and is it constant, recurrent or rapidly worsening?
3. [YES_NO] Is there any blurred, reduced, double or lost vision, halos, flashes/floaters, curtain/shadow, unequal pupil, inability to open or move the eye, or abnormal visual behavior in a child?
4. [YES_NO] Is the eye red, very light-sensitive, discharging, swollen, cloudy, or accompanied by severe headache, nausea or vomiting?
5. [YES_NO] Was there chemical splash, sharp/high-speed object, grinding or power-tool exposure, blunt trauma, foreign body, blood/fluid from the eye, or recent eye surgery/injection?
6. [YES_NO] Does the person wear contact lenses, are lenses still in, or did they sleep/swim/shower in lenses?
7. [YES_NO] For a baby or child, is there marked distress, refusal to open/use the eye, new squint, abnormal eye movement, fever with eyelid swelling, or caregiver concern about sight?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Eye - Allergy

Is itching, watering, and allergy-type irritation the main concern without significant eye pain, light sensitivity, or vision change?

Allergy-type eye symptoms without pain or vision change belong in the Eye Allergy pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is pain sudden or severe, or associated with any vision change, red eye plus severe headache/nausea/vomiting or halos, chemical exposure, penetrating/high-speed or major trauma, blood/fluid from the eye, inability to open/move the eye, serious neurological signs, or rapid deterioration after eye surgery/injection?

These may represent chemical injury, open globe/intraocular foreign body, acute angle-closure glaucoma, endophthalmitis, orbital or neurological emergency, or another sight-threatening condition. Telephone assessment cannot exclude them.

1. Disposition level 70

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent eye pain, red or light-sensitive eye, pain with eye movement, discharge/cloudiness, eyelid swelling, foreign-body sensation, contact-lens use, or pain/abnormal visual behavior in a child?

A red painful or photophobic eye and any painful contact-lens presentation require same-day in-person examination because keratitis, uveitis and other sight-threatening disease cannot be excluded remotely. Children may not reliably report vision change.

1. Disposition level 70

Even if discomfort sounds mild, has true eye pain not yet been distinguished in person from surface irritation, abrasion, infection, inflammation or pressure-related disease?

This UAT pathway does not diagnose dry eye or authorize self-care from a telephone description of pain. An age-appropriate eye examination is required.

Advice

Qatar sight-threatening eye response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not allow driving. For a chemical splash without suspected penetration, protect yourself, remove contact lenses only if easy, and immediately rinse with lots of clean room-temperature water for at least 20 minutes while help is arranged; do not neutralize the chemical and bring its container. For a penetrating/high-speed injury or suspected open globe, do not rinse, remove an object, rub, press, patch or apply drops/ointment; protect without pressure using a rigid shield or clean cup if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: vision change; worsening pain; vomiting; reduced responsiveness.

Same-day in-person ophthalmic assessment

- Arrange same-day assessment through an approved Qatar adult or pediatric ophthalmology pathway. Remove contact lenses if easy and do not reinsert them; do not use another person's, leftover, steroid, antibiotic or anaesthetic eye drops. Do not drive while pain or vision is affected. Call 999 for sudden/severe pain, vision change, chemical or penetrating/high-speed trauma, red eye with headache/nausea/vomiting, neurological signs or rapid worsening.
- Call Back If: vision changes; pain worsens; vomiting or severe headache; child stops opening or using the eye.

Telephone assessment cannot diagnose mild eye pain

- Arrange an age-appropriate in-person eye examination. Avoid rubbing, contact lenses and unprescribed drops while awaiting review. The exact Qatar non-emergency destination, transport and medication pathway are GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.
- Call Back If: pain worsens; redness, photophobia or vision change develops.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not allow driving. For a chemical splash without suspected penetration, protect yourself, remove contact lenses only if easy, and immediately rinse with lots of clean room-temperature water for at least 20 minutes while help is arranged; do not neutralize the chemical and bring its container. For a penetrating/high-speed injury or suspected open globe, do not rinse, remove an object, rub, press, patch or apply drops/ointment; protect without pressure using a rigid shield or clean cup if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- Qatar Ministry of Public Health, "Healthcare Services in Qatar", <https://sportandhealth.moph.gov.qa/EN/faninfo/Pages/HealthcareServicesInQatar.aspx> (accessed 2026-07-25)
- NHS.UK, "Eye injuries", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/eye-injuries/> (page reviewed 12 March 2026)
- NHS.UK, "Vision loss", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/vision-loss/> (page reviewed 28 August 2025)
- Royal Devon University Healthcare, "Emergency eye services" (accessed 2026-07-25)

Provenance

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